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Semiconductor packaging industry update

EQUITY: JAPAN ELECTRONIC PARTS

Research Analysts

Japan electronic parts

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Packaging substrate shipments up 52% y-y

ARR growth at major frontier AI lab represents useful barometer for AI data center investment

Packaging-related monthly statistics: August shipment value up 52% y-y

According to confirmed production data for August released on 15 October, shipments of flip-chip ball grid array (FC-BGA) package substrates (modularized rigid substrates) rose 52% y-y to ¥29.9bn. Shipments on a m² basis rose 2% and the average price per m² rose 48% to ¥1,491,000, beating the previous high of ¥1,429,000 reached in June. Shipment volume on a m² basis was lackluster y-y even though Ibiden's [4062] (Buy) Ono plant came on stream (we estimate that shipments started earnest around March 2026). We attribute this to a further rise in the shipment weighting of high-end multilayer packages in August, which crimped growth in shipment volumes on a m² basis. In particular, we estimate that shipments of EMIB for commodity servers rose. Taiwanese companies have been hiking prices for FC-BGA packages of late, potentially prompting Japanese packaging manufacturers to revise prices for low-margin products supplied to major CPU producers.

ARR and data center capex at Anthropic

Anthropic hosted a presentation for investors on 15 October. The Financial Times reported sales at Anthropic of $16.8bn in Jul–Sep, versus $11.5bn in Apr–Jun and $4.8bn in Jan–Mar. We have not verified this. We regard ARR at Anthropic as a useful barometer of data center capex, as we think it is currently able to monetize data center capacity better than any other frontier AI lab. For example, (1) assuming that Anthropic has data center capacity of 5GW and ARR of $120bn at end-2026, we estimate that 1GW in compute resources translates into annual sales of $20bn. In addition, (2) if 60% of this revenue is spent on purchasing computing resources, we estimate that it will be able to spend $12bn a year on 1GW of data center capacity, and (3) if data center equipment is depreciated over five years, $60bn per GW represents about the most that can be allocated to data center construction (while noting that data centers also incur operating costs, and that the depreciation scheduled for power infrastructure depreciation is longer than five years). Increased ARR per GW is likely to boost data center spending, and the opposite is likely to hold true too. Assuming that growth in ARR at Anthropic slowed q-q in Jul–Sep, as the Financial Times article suggested, we think this might encourage a slightly more cautious outlook towards data center investment. Moreover, even if rivals were to lose market share to Anthropic, we note that revenues per GW could come under downward pressure across the industry as a whole.

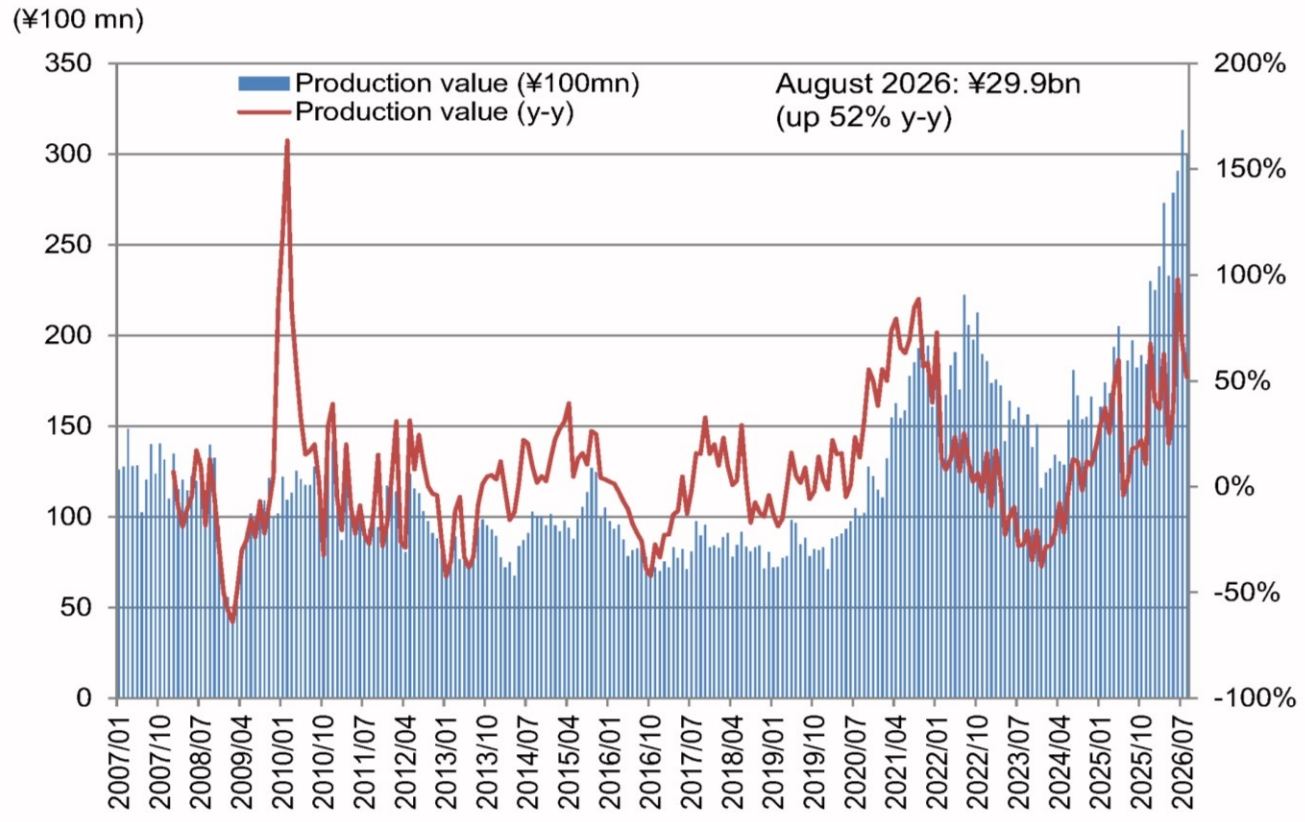
We expect uptake of multi-agent systems (MAS), in which agents collaborate among themselves to execute prompts, and think demand for computing resources will rise once cost-effectiveness has been demonstrated. We think it makes sense to gauge whether the current cost of data center construction is commensurate with the economic benefits that AI models generate by looking at ARR generated by Anthropic and other frontier AI labs, as well as at new services and inventions.

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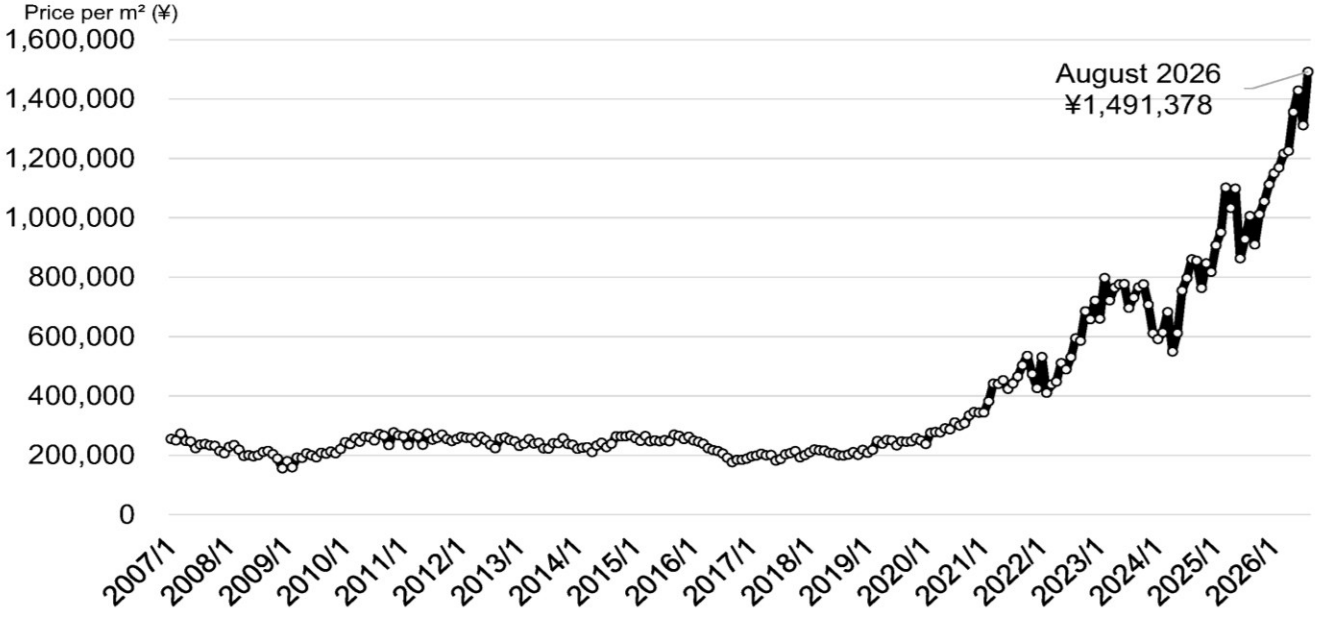
Reference figures

Fig. 1: Rigid PCB production value



Source: Nomura, based on Ministry of Economy, Trade & Industry's Current Survey of Production

Fig. 2: Price per m² for rigid module boards



Note: Module boards have components mounted on the board surface.
Source: Nomura, based on Ministry of Economy, Trade & Industry's Current Survey of Production

Appendix A-1

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Margin transactions are subject to a sales commission of up to 1.43% (tax included) of the transaction amount (or a commission of ¥2,860 (tax included) for transactions of ¥200,000 or less), as well as management fees and rights handling fees. In addition, long margin transactions are subject to interest on the purchase amount, while short margin transactions are subject to fees for the lending of the shares borrowed. A margin equal to at least 30% of the transaction amount (at least 33% for online transactions) and at least ¥300,000 is required. With margin transactions, an amount up to roughly 3.3x the margin (roughly 3x for online transactions) may be traded. Margin transactions therefore carry the risk of losses in excess of the margin owing to share price fluctuations. For details, please thoroughly read the written materials provided, such as listed securities documents or documents delivered before making a contract.

Transactions involving convertible bonds are subject to a sales commission of up to 1.10% (tax included) of the transaction amount (or a commission of ¥4,400 (tax included) if this would be less than ¥4,400). When convertible bonds are purchased via OTC transactions (including offerings), only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. However, Nomura Securities may charge a separate fee for OTC transactions, as agreed with the customer. Convertible bonds carry the risk of losses owing to factors such as interest rate fluctuations and price fluctuations in the underlying stock. In addition, convertible bonds denominated in foreign currencies also carry the risk of losses owing to factors such as foreign exchange rate fluctuations.

When bonds are purchased via public offerings, secondary distributions, or other OTC transactions with Nomura Securities, only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. Bonds carry the risk of losses, as prices fluctuate in line with changes in market interest rates. Bond prices may also fall below the invested principal as a result of such factors as changes in the management and financial circumstances of the issuer, or changes in third-party valuations of the bond in question. In addition, foreign currency-denominated bonds also carry the risk of losses owing to factors such as foreign exchange rate fluctuations.

When Japanese government bonds (JGBs) for individual investors are purchased via public offerings, only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. As a rule, JGBs for individual investors may not be sold in the first 12 months after issuance. When JGBs for individual investors are sold before maturity, an amount calculated via the following formula will be subtracted from the par value of the bond plus accrued interest: (1) for 10-year variable rate bonds, an amount equal to the two preceding coupon payments (before tax) x 0.79685 will be used, (2) for 5-year and 3-year fixed rate bonds, an amount equal to the two preceding coupon payments (before tax) x 0.79685 will be used.

When inflation-indexed JGBs are purchased via public offerings, secondary distributions (uridashi deals), or other OTC transactions with Nomura Securities, only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. Inflation-indexed JGBs carry the risk of losses, as prices fluctuate in line with changes in market interest rates and fluctuations in the nationwide consumer price index. The notional principal of inflation-indexed JGBs changes in line with the rate of change in nationwide CPI inflation from the time of its issuance. The amount of the coupon payment is calculated by multiplying the coupon rate by the notional principal at the time of payment. The maturity value is the amount of the notional principal when the issue becomes due. For JI17 and subsequent issues, the maturity value shall not undercut the face amount.

Purchases of investment trusts (and sales of some investment trusts) are subject to a purchase or sales fee of up to 5.5% (tax included) of the transaction amount. Also, a direct cost that may be incurred when selling investment trusts is a fee of up to 2.0% of the unit price at the time of redemption. Indirect costs that may be incurred during the course of holding investment trusts include, for domestic investment trusts, an asset

management fee (trust fee) of up to 5.5% (tax included/annualized basis) of the net assets in trust, as well as fees based on investment performance. Other indirect costs may also be incurred. For foreign investment trusts, indirect fees may be incurred during the course of holding such as investment company compensation.
Investment trusts invest mainly in securities such as Japanese and foreign equities and bonds, whose prices fluctuate. Investment trust unit prices fluctuate owing to price fluctuations in the underlying assets and to foreign exchange rate fluctuations. As such, investment trusts carry the risk of losses. Fees and risks vary by investment trust. Maximum applicable fees are subject to change; please thoroughly read the written materials provided, such as prospectuses or documents delivered before making a contract.
In interest rate swap transactions and USD/JPY basis swap transactions ("interest rate swap transactions, etc."), only the agreed transaction payments shall be made on the settlement dates. Some interest rate swap transactions, etc. may require pledging of margin collateral. In some of these cases, transaction payments may exceed the amount of collateral. There shall be no advance notification of required collateral value or collateral ratios as they vary depending on the transaction. Interest rate swap transactions, etc. carry the risk of losses owing to fluctuations in market prices in the interest rate, currency and other markets, as well as reference indices. Losses incurred as such may exceed the value of margin collateral, in which case margin calls may be triggered. In the event that both parties agree to enter a replacement (or termination) transaction, the interest rates received (paid) under the new arrangement may differ from those in the original arrangement, even if terms other than the interest rates are identical to those in the original transaction. Risks vary by transaction. Please thoroughly read the written materials provided, such as documents delivered before making a contract and disclosure statements.
In OTC transactions of credit default swaps (CDS), no sales commission will be charged. When entering into CDS transactions, the protection buyer will be required to pledge or entrust an agreed amount of margin collateral. In some of these cases, the transaction payments may exceed the amount of margin collateral. There shall be no advance notification of required collateral value or collateral ratios as they vary depending on the financial position of the protection buyer. CDS transactions carry the risk of losses owing to changes in the credit position of some or all of the referenced entities, and/or fluctuations of the interest rate market. The amount the protection buyer receives in the event that the CDS is triggered by a credit event may undercut the total amount of premiums that he/she has paid in the course of the transaction. Similarly, the amount the protection seller pays in the event of a credit event may exceed the total amount of premiums that he/she has received in the transaction. All other conditions being equal, the amount of premiums that the protection buyer pays and that received by the protection seller shall differ. In principle, CDS transactions will be limited to financial instruments business operators and qualified institutional investors.
Transfers of equities to another securities company via the Japan Securities Depository Center are subject to a transfer fee of up to ¥11,000 (tax included) per issue transferred depending on volume. No account fee will be charged for marketable securities or monies deposited.

Nomura Securities Co., Ltd.

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